

Vox Populi on CachyOS

Civilization V + Vox Populi via Steam and Proton

Revision 9.0.3 · 2026-09-19 · Verified against Vox Populi 5.4.6 (stable), Protontricks 1.14.1-1 and the Proton 11.0 source, on CachyOS with native Steam; Ubuntu, Debian, Fedora and Steam Deck in §3.

Every command block below is fish, the default login shell on CachyOS. Since the July 2025 snapshot the CachyOS installer also offers zsh or bash, and most other distributions default to bash; in bash or zsh, translate these five constructs:

fish	bash / zsh
set -g NAME "value"	NAME="value"
set NAME (command)	NAME="\$(command)"
cmd; and other	cmd && other
test -d x; and A; or B	if [-d x]; then A; else B; fi
for x in a b; ...; end	for x in a b; do ...; done

Blocks tagged fish are commands to run; untagged blocks are reference tables and paths. Every step ends in a check you can run. WARNING marks a common failure; CRITICAL marks a step that decides whether this works at all.

The same guide is also here as vox-populi-cachyos.pdf (print-ready, US Letter) and vox-populi-cachyos-print.html.

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1. How it works

Proton is mandatory. Vox Populi ships a compiled game-core DLL built against the Civ V SDK. The native Aspyr Linux build cannot load it, so the Windows build under Proton is the only working configuration.

The installer is Inno Setup 6 (Installer Version 1.2), a plain Win32 wizard that renders correctly under Proton. Reports about .NET installers failing under Wine do not apply.

It asks for two different paths. This is the crux.

Wizard page	Resolves to	Receives
Select Destination Location – the Documents path LEAVE THIS ALONE	{userdocs}\My Games\ Sid Meier's Civilization 5 Under Proton: C:\users\steamuser\ Documents\... (in the prefix)	MODS\ (1) Community Patch MODS\ (2) Vox Populi MODS\ (3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files MODS\ (3b) 43 Civs Community Patch MODS\ (4a) Squads for VP MODS\ (5) Modpack Maker for VP Text\VPUI_tips_en_us.xml
Select the Civilization V folder – custom page, right after the setup-type page THIS IS THE ONE THAT GOES WRONG	Whatever you browse to. Must be the REAL game install, reached through Z:\ (Wine maps Z: to /)	Assets\DLC\VPUI Assets\DLC\UI_bc1 (EUI only) Assets\DLC\Expansion2\ Expansion2.Civ5Pkg (replaced) Assets\DLC\Expansion2\Sounds\ XML\MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli

The Documents default is already correct — it resolves inside the prefix, where the Windows build reads mods from. The Civilization V folder page auto-fills only if a Windows-style Steam path already exists inside the prefix, which on a clean prefix it does not; the field arrives blank.

CRITICAL — Aim that page at the real Linux install and nothing ever needs copying. The wizard refuses any folder that lacks an Assets\DLC child or any of the ten DLC folders, so on a clean prefix a wrong path is blocked rather than installed. A Windows-style game tree already inside the prefix — a copied install, for example — passes that test, and the UI assets then land where the game will never read them. This is why some guides require a copy step and others do not.

Every DLC must be installed, not merely owned. The wizard checks for DLC_01–DLC_07, DLC_Deluxe, Expansion, Expansion2 and blocks installation if any is missing. In practice that is the Complete Edition set on Civ V 1.0.3.279; the installer's information page names the Mongols, Spain & Inca, Polynesia, Denmark and Korea leader packs, Wonders of the Ancient World, Gods & Kings and Brave New World. Of the folder names, DLC_Deluxe is the Babylon pack, Expansion is Gods & Kings and Expansion2 is Brave New World.

It cleans up after itself. Before writing it deletes the prefix cache, the current VP mod folders, and legacy CBP/CBO/CSD folder names. Do not clear the cache or delete old versions by hand. The corollary: anything you edit inside a VP mod folder is destroyed by the next install or update.

There is no uninstaller entry (Uninstallable=no). Removal is the **Uninstall all** setup type in the same .exe.

Stable and beta releases both exist. Each GitHub release links a release-notes thread titled *New STABLE Version* or *New BETA Version*. 5.4.6 (2026-08-31) is stable.

2. Requirements

Game	Civilization V 1.0.3.279, all expansions and all DLC installed
Steam	Native Steam (multilib `steam`); data dir ~/.local/share/Steam, also reachable through ~/.steam/root. Other distributions: §3
Compat tool	Proton Experimental or newest numbered Proton (11.0 at this revision); proton-cachyos-slr OK. NOT "Steam Linux Runtime" – that is not Proton
Tooling	extra/protontricks 1.14.1-1 – pulls winetricks, which pulls wine and cabextract; yad and zenity for the GUIs; ripgrep, rsync, zip for this guide's own checks and backups
Disk	Full re-download of the Windows depots, plus ~105 MB installer
Conflicts	No Workshop subscriptions to Community Patch, More Luxuries, City-State Diplomacy, Civ IV Diplomatic Features; no mod shipping its own DLL

Set these once; every command below uses them.

```
set -g CIV5_LIB "$HOME/.local/share/Steam"
set -g CIV5_GAME "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V"
set -g CIV5_PFX "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/drive_c"
set -g CIV5_DOCS "$CIV5_PFX/users/steamuser/Documents/My Games/Sid Meier's Civilization 5"
```

CIV5_LIB is the Steam library that holds Civ V. The value above is native Steam's default library on CachyOS; §3 lists the defaults for other packagings. compatdata/8930 always lives in the same library as the game. If Civ V sits in a secondary library, print the one that holds it:

```
rg -o '"path"\s+"([^\s]+)"' -r '${1}/steamapps/appmanifest_8930.acf' \
"$HOME/.steam/root/steamapps/libraryfolders.vdf" | xargs -r -d '\n' ls 2>/dev/null
```

It runs unchanged in bash and prints the appmanifest_8930.acf of the library that holds Civ V. Set CIV5_LIB to the part before /steamapps and re-run all four lines above; the other three are built from it at the moment they are set. Flatpak and Snap Steam keep libraryfolders.vdf under their own directory from §3 rather than ~/.steam/root.

3. Other distributions

From Step 1 on, only the Step 4 package command is specific to CachyOS: the wizard, the paths inside the prefix and the in-game steps are the same everywhere. Three things differ — how Steam is installed, where its default library sits (CIV5_LIB), and whether the distribution's own Protontricks is recent enough.

Protontricks 1.12.0 is the floor: older releases cannot read the appinfo.vdf format the current Steam client writes and stop with "Invalid file magic number".

Distribution	Steam	Protontricks
CachyOS, Arch Ubuntu 26.04 LTS Ubuntu 24.04 LTS	steam (multilib) steam-installer (multiverse) steam-installer (multiverse)	extra, 1.14.1 – Step 4 multiverse, 1.13.1 – use it multiverse, 1.10.5 – too old; use the Flatpak
Debian 13 Fedora 44 Steam Deck	steam-installer (contrib) steam (RPM Fusion Nonfree) preinstalled	none in trixie; use the Flatpak fedora, 1.14.0 – use it Flatpak, from Discover

Where the default library sits — the value for CIV5_LIB unless Civ V lives in a secondary library:

Steam packaging	CIV5_LIB for the default library
Native package, any distro Arch, CachyOS Debian, Ubuntu	whatever realpath ~/.steam/root prints ~/.local/share/Steam ~/.steam/debian-installation for a new install; older installs may sit in ~/.local/share/Steam
Flatpak Steam Snap Steam	~/.var/app/com.valvesoftware.Steam/.local/share/Steam ~/snap/steam/common/.local/share/Steam

Ubuntu 26.04 LTS — everything comes from the archive:

```
sudo dpkg --add-architecture i386
sudo add-apt-repository multiverse
sudo apt update
sudo apt install steam-installer protontricks yad cabextract ripgrep rsync zip curl
```

Ubuntu 24.04 LTS — its Protontricks is too old, so the Flatpak replaces it:

```
sudo dpkg --add-architecture i386
sudo add-apt-repository multiverse
sudo apt update
sudo apt install steam-installer flatpak ripgrep rsync zip curl
flatpak remote-add --if-not-exists flathub https://dl.flathub.org/repo/flathub.flatpakrepo
```

Debian 13 — first add contrib to the components of your trixie APT sources, as the Debian wiki's Steam page shows:

```
sudo dpkg --add-architecture i386
sudo apt update
sudo apt install steam-installer mesa-vulkan-drivers \
libglx-mesa0:i386 mesa-vulkan-drivers:i386 libgl1-mesa-dri:i386
sudo apt install flatpak ripgrep rsync zip curl
flatpak remote-add --if-not-exists flathub https://dl.flathub.org/repo/flathub.flatpakrepo
```

The Mesa packages are the wiki's list for Vulkan and 32-bit titles on 64-bit systems; they serve the open-source AMD and Intel drivers. With NVIDIA's proprietary driver, install its 32-bit libraries instead: `sudo apt install nvidia-driver-libs:i386`.

Fedora 44 — Steam comes from RPM Fusion Nonfree, Protontricks from Fedora itself. In bash, write `$(rpm -E %fedora)`:

```
sudo dnf install \
https://mirrors.rpmfusion.org/nonfree/fedora/rpmfusion-nonfree-release-(rpm -E %fedora).noarch.rpm
sudo dnf install steam protontricks yad cabextract ripgrep rsync zip
```

Steam Deck — in Desktop Mode, install Protontricks from Discover, which is upstream's recommendation for the Deck. SteamOS keeps its root filesystem read-only, so nothing is added with pacman; if a tool this guide calls is missing, substitute — `grep -i` for `rg -i`, for example.

Then, on any of them:

1. If you just added Flathub, restart first.
2. With the Flatpak (Ubuntu 24.04, Debian 13, Steam Deck), install Protontricks from the Flatpak block in Step 4, aliases included.
3. Start Steam once and sign in, so it creates its directories.

4. Set CIV5_LIB in §2 from the second table — inside the quotes, write ~ as \$HOME — and re-run all four lines.

```
realpath ~/.steam/root
protontricks --version
```

Check: the first line prints your Steam directory (native packages only), the second 1.12.0 or newer. Continue with Step 1.

4. Stage A — game under Proton

Step 1 · Force Proton

Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **Compatibility** → tick **Force the use of a specific Steam Play compatibility tool** → Proton Experimental or the newest numbered Proton. Steam replaces the native build with the Windows depots; let it finish. A download that stops with a disk write error may be a Steam client bug — see §13.

WARNING — The same dropdown lists Steam Linux Runtime entries. They are not Proton: no Wine prefix is set up, and protontricks-launch stops with "Proton installation could not be found!"; its log adds that the active compatibility tool is not a Proton installation.

CachyOS alternatives (install, restart Steam): proton-cachyos-slr, proton-cachyos-native, or protonup-qt / protonplus for Proton-GE. Prefer -slr: it is a Proton build packaged to run inside the Steam Linux Runtime container, which is not the same thing as the bare *Steam Linux Runtime* entries warned about above.

S: drive: Proton 11.0 and Proton Experimental map S: to the game's Steam library by default — their launch script turns gamedrive on for every game. On Proton 10.0 or older, set the launch option PROTON_SET_GAME_DRIVE=1 %command% for the same effect. The drive shortens the browse in Step 7. Verify after Step 3 with `ls -l "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/dosdevices":` s: should point at the library root, the folder that holds steamapps (when that root is not writable, or sits on a different filesystem from steamapps, Proton points it at steamapps itself and the wizard path becomes S:\common\...); if no s: appears, use the Z: path instead.

Step 2 · Confirm every DLC

Steam → Properties → **DLC** → tick everything, then:

```
for d in DLC_01 DLC_02 DLC_03 DLC_04 DLC_05 DLC_06 DLC_07 DLC_Deluxe Expansion Expansion2
do test -d "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/$d"; and echo "ok $d"; or echo "MISS $d"
end
```

Check: ten ok lines. Any MISS stops the installer at Step 7.

Step 3 · Launch once, reach the main menu, quit

This creates compatdata/8930/pfx, without which Protontricks cannot see the game, and lets Civ V build its Documents tree inside the prefix. If the Firaxis launcher appears, choose DirectX 10/11 — an upstream report (Proton #8327) notes the DX9 executable may start regardless; this does not affect Vox Populi.

Check:

```
ls "$CIV5_PFX"      # Program Files, Program Files (x86), users, windows
ls "$CIV5_DOCS"    # expect Logs, Saves, config.ini among others
```

5. Stage B — install Vox Populi

Step 4 · Protontricks and runtime libraries

```
sudo pacman -S --needed protontricks yad zenity ripgrep rsync zip
protontricks --version
protontricks -s civilization
```

Check: the version is 1.12.0 or newer, and the search prints Sid Meier's Civilization V with app ID **8930**. Nothing printed means Step 3 did not complete. Other distributions install Protontricks as §3 describes.

Flatpak Protontricks, or Flatpak Steam (alternative)

```
flatpak install flathub com.github.Matoking.protontricks
flatpak override --user --filesystem=$HOME/Downloads com.github.Matoking.protontricks
# one --filesystem= override per Steam library outside the default location
alias --save protontricks 'flatpak run com.github.Matoking.protontricks'
alias --save protontricks-launch 'flatpak run --command=protontricks-launch com.github.Matoking.protontricks'
```

The two aliases let every later command in this guide run unchanged; in bash, the Protontricks README appends the same two aliases to ~/.bashrc. Flatpak Protontricks is sandboxed to the Steam directory; without an override covering the .exe you are launching, it reports that it "does not appear to have access to the following directories" and prints the exact flatpak override command to run. Separately, if *Steam itself* is the Flatpak, every path in §17 moves under ~/.var/app/com.valvesoftware.Steam/.

Then install the Visual C++ 2008 runtime and Microsoft's core fonts into the game's prefix:

```
protontricks 8930 -q vcrun2008 corefonts
protontricks 8930 list-installed
```

Check: the list includes vcrun2008 and corefonts.

The Vox Populi game-core DLL (CvGameCore_Expansion2.dll, both variants in 5.4.6) imports MSVCR90.dll and MSVCP90.dll — the Visual C++ 2008 runtime that vcrun2008 installs. Wine's built-in copies usually suffice, but a report in thread 702075 had VP working only after this step. corefonts adds Microsoft's ten core web fonts, Arial, Courier New and Times New Roman among them, and needs cabextract. Everything after the app ID goes to Winetricks, which is why -q (unattended) sits there; Winetricks skips verbs that are already installed, so re-running is harmless. Both verbs download their installers, so this needs network access.

The command in that report also set variables. WINEDEBUG=-all only silences Wine's debug output. PROTON_NO_FSYNC=1 turns off fsync, which Protontricks enables by default — put it in front if a verb hangs. Nothing in this chain reads WINE_DISABLE_NICE — not Valve's Wine 11.0, CachyOS's Wine, the Proton launcher, Protontricks or Winetricks. A leading WINEPREFIX= is ignored as well, because Protontricks sets the prefix from the app ID itself.

Step 5 · Download and verify

Releases are GitHub assets on LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL, named Vox.Populi.<version>.exe.

```
curl -L -o "$HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe" \
  https://github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/releases/download/Release-5.4.6/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe
sha256sum "$HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe"
```

Check: 31679423e55d7f64ba9693d8252d9e29f824fd9f8da043af547470068f98ba8a

For other versions, take the digest from that release's asset listing and confirm STABLE vs BETA in its release-notes thread title. Release_Debug.zip is a debug DLL for crash reports, not needed for play.

Step 6 · Run it inside the prefix

```
protontricks-launch --appid 8930 "$HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe"
```

GUI: right-click the .exe → **Open With** → **Protontricks Launcher** → Sid Meier's Civilization V.

Flatpak without the Step 4 aliases: flatpak run --command=protontricks-launch
com.github.Matoking.protontricks --appid 8930 <exe>

The wizard can take a minute to appear and may not be raised to the foreground under Wayland. A 64-bit WINEPREFIX warning is expected and documented — Civ V is 32-bit inside a 64-bit prefix.

Step 7 · Work the wizard

	Page	Action
★	License · Information	Next
★	Select Destination Location	LEAVE UNCHANGED. Must read C:\users\steamuser\Documents\My Games\Sid Meier's Civilization 5
★	Setup Type / Components	Choose one variant – table below
★	Select the Civilization V folder	Browse to S:\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V, or to the Z:\ path that the command under these tables prints
	Start Menu folder	May be skipped; irrelevant under Proton, Next
	Ready to Install	CHECK "Civilization V path" shows the S:\ or Z:\ path, not C:\Program Files (x86)\...
	Installing · Finished	Wait, Finish

Vox Populi (with EUI)	Full VP + Enhanced User Interface – the usual choice
Vox Populi (no EUI)	Full VP, stock interface
Community Patch only	AI and bugfix base mod. NOT compatible with EUI
43 Civ ... (three variants)	Same options with a DLL supporting 43 major civs
Uninstall all	Removal path – §12

The Z:\ form of your install, ready to type into the folder field:

```
echo "Z:$CIV5_GAME" | tr / "\\\\"
```

The line runs unchanged in bash. If the Ready page shows a C:\Program Files (x86) path, go back and fix it rather than copying files afterwards. The installer also fails if the MODS folder has been moved out of the Documents tree — under Proton that only happens if you change the Documents page yourself.

Step 8 · Verify placement

```
ls "$CIV5_DOCS/MODS" # (1)...(5) for your variant
ls "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC" | rg -i 'VPUI|UI_bc1' # VPUI, + UI_bc1 for EUI
ls "$CIV5_PFX/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V/Assets/DLC" 2>/dev/null
```

The second command is the pass/fail test for Step 7: a Vox Populi variant shows VPUI, plus UI_bc1 with EUI. Community Patch only installs neither; there, look for Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml under the same Assets/DLC instead. The third must print nothing; on a clean prefix that tree does not exist, so output means a game tree inside the prefix took the files. If it lists VPUI or UI_bc1, re-run the installer with the correct path. Fallback if you would rather not:

```
rsync -a --dry-run \
"$CIV5_PFX/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V/Assets/" \
"$CIV5_GAME/Assets/"
```

Inspect, then re-run without --dry-run. Note there is no Assets/DLC/Vox Populi folder — the installer creates VPUI for the Vox Populi variants and, with EUI, UI_bc1.

6. Stage C — first run

1. Launch Civ V from Steam.
2. Main menu → **MODS**; accept the prompt about DLC being disabled and the game restarting.
3. The first entry into the mods menu runs a long "configuring game data" pass — from under a minute to 5–15 minutes. Not a hang. The opening post of thread 702075 reports that this first pass may crash once and works after a relaunch.
4. Enable the VP mods the installer placed in MODS.
5. Press **NEXT**, never **Back**.
6. **Single Player** → **Set Up Game**.

CRITICAL — Back returns to the main menu and silently deactivates the mod set. The installer's own finish screen says to enable all installed mods and click Next, not Back. This is the most common "I installed VP and nothing changed" report.

(2) Vox Populi	Requires (1) Community Patch
(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files	MUST be enabled on any EUI install, or VP will not function
(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch	Only for 43-civ variants
(4a) Squads for VP	Optional QoL – RTS-style control groups on CTRL+number
(5) Modpack Maker for VP	Leave off for normal play; builds modpacks (\$10)

Check: the main menu lists active mods in the lower right. EUI working but no new units, luxuries, or advanced-setup options means the base game with EUI only — redo from the MODS menu without pressing Back.

7. Settings and stability

Setting	Single player	Multiplayer
Autosave frequency	1 turn	1 turn
Max autosaves	0 (unlimited)	500
Leader Scene Quality	Minimum	Minimum
Yield icons	Off from the Industrial era	Off from the Industrial era – every player must do it

The single-player figures are what the install thread and the project's bug-report form both ask for; the modpack thread asks for 500 in multiplayer. The purpose is the same either way: the bug form wants a save from the turn *before* the problem, which only exists if autosaves are frequent and not being rotated away.

Late-game crashes are a memory problem, not a Vox Populi bug. Civ V is a 32-bit executable and the project attributes most late-game CTDs to address-space exhaustion. Mitigations, the first being the one the project calls most important for solo play: Leader Scene Quality on Minimum; yield icons off from the Industrial era (avoid zooming far out if you keep them); standard or small maps; lower in-game resolution. Ultrawide and 4K panels sit at the demanding end of that last point.

Proton helps here: `PROTON_FORCE_LARGE_ADDRESS_AWARE` is **on by default**, giving the 32-bit executable a 4 GB address space instead of 2 GB. Leave it alone.

Early, random crashes are a different problem. ProtonDB reporters tie them to the thread count. On the Windows build under Proton the reported fix is to pin the game to eight threads with the launch option `taskset -c 0-7 %command%`; one reporter instead raised `MaxSimultaneousThreads` in `$CIV5_DOCS/config.ini` (8 by default) to the thread count `nproc` prints, and another found that 24 stopped the game from starting. The many reports that edit that key under `~/local/share/Aspyr` concern the native build; Proton does not read that file.

```
nproc
rg -n 'MaxSimultaneousThreads' "$CIV5_DOCS/config.ini"
```

Check: compare the two numbers before changing anything.

Late-game turn times are AI-bound, not GPU-bound. Treat graphics settings as a memory lever rather than a frame-rate one, and cap the frame rate at the panel's refresh rate with V-Sync.

8. Adding other mods

Any mod that ships its own DLL is incompatible. VP replaces the Civ V DLL entirely, and the Community Patch cannot coexist with another DLL mod. Steam Workshop subscriptions do not reliably land in the right place under Proton. Download from CivFanatics or GitHub and extract manually. Mods go in `$CIV5_DOCS/MODS` – inside the prefix, beside the VP folders. After ANY mod change, delete `cache/` and `ModUserData/` before launching. Stale cache is the single most common reason mods look broken after a change. Filenames do not need lowercasing under Proton; that applies to the native build.

```
rm -rf "$CIV5_DOCS/cache" "$CIV5_DOCS/ModUserData"
```

Check the CivFanatics "MODS compatible with Vox Populi (VP)" thread before adding anything; VP reworks most systems, so mods that touch game components are often only partly compatible. Reported working on Linux under Proton: Community Events, Improved City View (Gazebo's version), most of WHoward's Pick'N'Mix, and Info Addict (which needs an extra patch alongside EU1). The modpack thread's maintainer warns that Info Addict is known to cause crashes from memory overflow; weigh it against §7.

9. Optional tuning

9.1 Community Patch options file

Open this file in your editor:

```
$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(1) Community Patch/Database Changes/NewCustomModOptions.xml
```

Rules from the file's own header: an option with a **"See also:"** comment must be enabled through its mod, not here; one listing **"Defines:"** or **"PostDefines:"** needs those defines verified first; anything else is enabled by changing Value from 0 to 1.

Each row carries a Class saying what kind of option it is, not how safe it is:

0	Data	Values consumed by other options
1	Bugfix	Unused – bugfixes are always on in the Community Patch
2	API	Extensions with no effect unless another mod uses them
3	Events	Gamecore triggers – significant overhead even when unused
4	Minor	Limited gameplay changes
5	Moderate	Noticeable gameplay changes
6	Major	Significant gameplay changes

Leave Class 3 alone unless you need it; the header warns that those run triggers from the gamecore whether or not anything consumes them. The file holds the mod's entire option set — 29 API-class rows alone — of which these four are the ones most people want:

ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS	Steam achievements in modded single-player. Marked "FUNCTIONALITY NOT GUARANTEED" and it changes the savegame format – set it before a campaign, not during
DIPLO_DEBUG_MODE (+ ..._SETTING)	Reveals the AI's true opinion, approach and Congress voting; at setting 2 the AI accepts every Discuss request. The best window into how VP scores you
SQLITE_LOGGING	Writes gameplay statistics to a queryable stats.db
CORE_DEBUGGING	Extra gamecore debugging; slows the game, leave off

Clear the cache after editing, and keep a copy — the installer rewrites these folders on every update.

Use ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS rather than the executable-patching method circulated for other modded Civ V setups; it is unnecessary here. Related: map-type achievements are broken on the native Linux build regardless of mods, but work under Proton.

9.2 Back up before updating

```
set stamp (date +%Y%m%d)
set dest "$HOME/civ5-backup-$stamp"
mkdir -p "$dest"
rsync -a "$CIV5_DOCS/Saves" "$CIV5_DOCS/MODS" "$dest"/
```

Saves live inside the Wine prefix, so a full prefix reset destroys them too.

10. Multiplayer

VP cannot be played in multiplayer through the MODS menu; it must be packaged as a modpack that loads automatically as a DLC.

Preferred — a prebuilt modpack. The CivFanatics modpack thread tracks current releases (5.4.6), including one generated on Linux under Proton. Extract so the modpack folder sits directly under `$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/`, then `rm -rf "$CIV5_DOCS/cache"`. Modpacks also work in single player and are easier to update than a mods-menu install.

Or build your own: enable (5) Modpack Maker for VP plus every mod to include → start or load a game → **Ctrl-Shift-M** → check `$CIV5_DOCS/Logs/Lua.log` for errors → exit → `rm -rf "$CIV5_DOCS/cache"` → relaunch and start from Single Player or Multiplayer, never the MODS menu.

Or let civ5vp-installer build one (§14). Packs it built before version 0.1.6 can show raw text keys for loading tips and EUI options; rebuild those.

Modpacks cannot be combined with mods activated through the MODS menu
Every player must use byte-identical modpacks
Every player must delete cache/ BEFORE EVERY LAUNCH, or the game will most likely crash after the first turn
Do not hand-edit Assets\DLC\VP_MODPACK – rebuild instead
Saves do not record which modpack was used; a mismatch crashes
Multiplayer autosaves live in Saves\multi\auto – collect them for desync reports

Remove with `rm -rf "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/VP_MODPACK" "$CIV5_DOCS/cache"`.

An open upstream report, Community-Patch-DLL #13349 (2026-09-05), describes a multiplayer desync on 5.4.x that its reporter suspects lies in pathfinding. Check its state before starting a long multiplayer game.

MPPatch, which would allow modded multiplayer without modpacks, has had no release since December 2023, and a forum report describes crashes when combined with VP plus EUI. Modpacks remain the supported route.

11. Updating

Run the newer `Vox.Populi.<version>.exe` exactly as in Steps 6–7. It deletes the old mod folders and cache before writing; no manual cleanup. Take the §9.2 backup first if you have edited anything under MODS.

By the project's versioning rule, saves are compatible when only the third version component changes: 5.4.4 → 5.4.6 keeps them, 5.4.x → 5.5.0 does not.

WARNING — Steam's *Verify integrity of game files* restores the stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg`, which VP replaces to fix city-state audio (including the BNW bug where Cape Town uses Almaty's clip). Re-run the VP installer after any verify.

12. Uninstalling

Preferred, because it restores the stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg`: re-run the installer, choose **Uninstall all**, and point the Civilization V folder page at the same real install.

Manual fallback. Swap `rm -rf` for `ls -d` first and confirm the list resolves as expected.

```
rm -rf "$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(1) Community Patch" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(2) Vox Populi" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(4a) Squads for VP" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(5) Modpack Maker for VP" \
"$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/VPUI" \
"$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/UI_bc1" \
"$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/VP_MODPACK" \
"$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/cache" "$CIV5_DOCS/ModUserData" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/Text/VPUI_tips_en_us.xml"
```

Then verify game files in Steam to restore the stock Expansion2.Civ5Pkg. Verification re-downloads changed files but leaves added ones in place, which is why the sound XML the installer adds is in the list above.

Full prefix reset (destroys in-prefix saves — back up first): `rm -rf "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930"`

13. Troubleshooting

Ordered by when the failure appears. **Setup and install:**

Symptom	Cause and fix
Steam: "disk write error" while it downloads the Windows depots (Step 1)	Steam client bug with case-mismatched depot folders (steam-for-linux #13406; the Civ V report is #13436), closed as completed 2026-07-27. Update Steam and retry; reporters created the folder the error names, in that exact case, under steamapps/downloading/8930.
Crashes on NVIDIA	Two May 2026 ProtonDB reports crash on drivers 580.142 and 595.71.05; one reverted the driver. A July report on 580.105.08 runs. Not a VP fault.
protontricks does not list Civ V	Prefix absent. Launch once via Proton (Step 3).
protontricks: "Found multiple Steam directories"	Native and Flatpak or Snap Steam both exist. Put <code>STEAM_DIR=<the right one></code> in front of the command.
"Proton installation could not be found!"	Compat tool is a Steam Linux Runtime entry, not Proton. Re-select a real Proton build (Step 1).
Flatpak: "does not appear to have access to the following directories"	Run the flatpak override <code>--user --filesystem=...</code> command the message prints, then restart Protontricks (Step 4).
"Invalid file magic number"	Protontricks older than 1.12.0 cannot read the current <code>appinfo.vdf</code> . Upgrade, or use the Flatpak (§3).
"Unknown option --no-bwrap"	Protontricks options go BEFORE the app ID.
"Unknown arg <verb>"	Winetricks predates the verb; Debian and Ubuntu packages lag. Use the Flatpak, or upstream Winetricks.
"command cabextract ... returned status 1"	<code>cabextract</code> trips over a symlink Proton created. Delete the symlink the error names, then re-run.
"Cannot find cabextract"	Install the <code>cabextract</code> package (§3 lists it).
A Winetricks verb hangs	The thread-702075 report set <code>PROTON_NO_FSYNC=1</code> in front of the command (Step 4); try that.
"warning: 64-bit WINEPREFIX"	Expected. Civ V is 32-bit. Ignore.
Wizard never appears	Wayland focus or a broken Proton build. Check other windows, then try Proton Experimental or <code>proton-cachyos-slr</code> .
"You don't have all required DLCs"	Missing DLC under the chosen path. Enable every DLC in Steam and re-run the Step 2 loop.
"did not provide the correct path"	Chosen folder has no <code>Assets\DLC</code> child. Point at the game root, not <code>Assets</code> or <code>DLC</code> .

In the game:

Symptom	Cause and fix
Crash during the first configuring game data pass VP absent from the in-game mod list	The thread-702075 opening post saw this once; relaunch and enter MODS again (§6). Documents page was changed; mods are outside the prefix. Re-run with the default Documents path. Civ V folder page pointed at a game tree inside the prefix. Re-run, or copy across per Step 8.
Missing textures, broken UI	Back was pressed in MODS, or (3a) is not enabled on an EUI install. Re-enable all mods, press NEXT.
EUI works, no other VP features	rm -rf cache/ and ModUserData/ (§8). Then look for Workshop subscriptions sharing mod IDs, or a mod with its own DLL.
Mods stale, duplicated or missing	Cache not cleared, or the option needed its defines. §9.1.
CustomModOption change has no effect Still broken after all of the above	Minimal install – VP without EUI, no other mods – then add EUI, then other mods, one layer at a time.
Random crashes early in a session	Thread count (ProtonDB reports). Pin to eight threads with taskset, or align MaxSimultaneousThreads (§7).
Crash to desktop in the late game	32-bit address-space exhaustion. Apply §7 in order, and keep \$CIV5_GAME/crashlogs for a report (§15).
Crackling audio	One ProtonDB report: PULSE_LATENCY_MSEC=60 %command%.
Multiplayer crashes after turn 1	Cache not cleared before launch by every player (§10).
DX9 starts despite choosing DX11	Proton report #8327, closed as not planned. Not a VP fault.
DX11 hangs after a few minutes	A January 2026 ProtonDB report ran stable with the launch option -dx9; another saw grey screen areas under DX9.

14. Alternative installer

github.com/Alpakinator/civ5vp-installer — a single-file native Linux binary (Apache-2.0) that installs VP without Protontricks. It finds the Civ V folders by itself (you can correct them), writes only to the game's MODS, DLC and Text folders and its cache, offers a modpack mode, and has an Uninstall button that restores an unmodded game. It can also install unofficial or in-development versions; those it compiles locally, which costs about 1.1 GB of build tools once and roughly 5 GB in its data folder, ~/.local/share/civ5vp-installer. Its documentation states the same Proton-only constraint as §1. Newer and less battle-tested than the Protontricks route; a reasonable fallback if the Inno wizard misbehaves.

```
curl -L -o "$HOME/Downloads/civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64" \
https://github.com/Alpakinator/civ5vp-installer/releases/download/v0.1.6/civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64
sha256sum "$HOME/Downloads/civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64"
chmod +x "$HOME/Downloads/civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64"
"$HOME/Downloads/civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64"
```

Check: a0b59eb445d23bc9a5206ec0f592a7f81c4cfd40a5f2e0d823737bacbd271baa for v0.1.6 (2026-09-15).

WARNING — Install release versions only. On 2026-08-26 the author advised against its "Compile the DLL myself" option, single player included: the compiler it currently uses probably drops loop checks from the C++ code, which can freeze the game.

Packs built by versions before 0.1.6 can show raw text keys for loading tips and EUI options (upstream issue #13364); rebuild and redistribute them with 0.1.6.

15. Bug reporting

Bugs in Vox Populi go to the project's GitHub issue tracker, not the forum, where they are likely to be ignored; errors in this guide belong on this repository's tracker. Blank issues are disabled upstream, so the bug form is the only route. It requires the mod version and the components you installed — note the setup type you chose in Step 7 — and asks you to always attach three things where possible:

Save from one turn before the problem	\$CIV5_DOCS/Saves – the reason for the autosave settings in §7
Logs	\$CIV5_DOCS/Logs – useless unless logging was already on
Crash artifacts, when reporting a crash	\$CIV5_GAME/crashlogs for crashes.log and the .dmp, per the issue form. The minidump guide instead says dumps land beside the game executable as CvMiniDump_*.dmp – check both; the command below covers them.

Logging is off by default and must be on *before* the problem occurs. Enable it once per game installation in \$CIV5_DOCS/config.ini by setting ValidateGameDatabase, LoggingEnabled, MessageLog, AILog, AIPerfLog, BuilderAILog and PlayerAndCityAILogSplit to 1. (The project's developer docs write this path with "Civilization V"; the folder is "Civilization 5".) Collect the logs *before* loading a game — most are erased on load.

```
cd "$CIV5_DOCS"; and zip -r ~/civ5-vp-logs.zip Logs
cd "$CIV5_GAME"; and zip -r ~/civ5-vp-crash.zip crashlogs
cd "$CIV5_GAME"; and find . -maxdepth 1 -name 'CvMiniDump_*.dmp' -exec zip ~/civ5-vp-crash.zip {} +
```

Dump generation is not guaranteed under Proton: the DLL loads dbghelp.dll from the prefix's System32, so it depends on Wine's implementation rather than the Windows one the feature was written against. If no dump appears after a crash, say so in the report and attach the logs and save instead.

Turn logging back off when you are not chasing a bug; it rewrites a large directory continuously.

The project wiki carries its own guidance on writing a useful report, a full changelog, a Lua API reference for modders, and a page explaining the linked and group movement that (4a) Squads for VP builds on.

16. Command appendix

```
# CIV5_LIB: native Steam on CachyOS; other packagings in §3
set -g CIV5_LIB "$HOME/.local/share/Steam"
set -g CIV5_GAME "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V"
set -g CIV5_PFX "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/drive_c"
set -g CIV5_DOCS "$CIV5_PFX/users/steamuser/Documents/My Games/Sid Meier's Civilization 5"

sudo pacman -S --needed protontricks yad zenity ripgrep rsync zip

# [Steam] Compatibility > force a Proton build (not a Linux Runtime)
# [Steam] DLC > enable everything
# [Steam] Proton 10.0 or older only: launch option PROTON_SET_GAME_DRIVE=1 %command%

for d in DLC_01 DLC_02 DLC_03 DLC_04 DLC_05 DLC_06 DLC_07 DLC_Deluxe Expansion Expansion2
do
    test -d "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/$d"; and echo "ok $d"; or echo "MISS $d"
done

# [Steam] launch once, reach the main menu, quit
ls "$CIV5_PFX"
ls -l "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/dosdevices"
protontricks --version
protontricks -s civilization
protontricks 8930 -q vcrun2008 corefonts
protontricks 8930 list-installed
```

```

curl -L -o "$HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe" \
  https://github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/releases/download/Release-5.4.6/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe
sha256sum "$HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe"
# 31679423e55d7f64ba9693d8252d9e29f824fd9f8da043af547470068f98ba8a

echo "Z:$CIV5_GAME" | tr / "\\\\"
# Documents page unchanged; Civ V folder browsed to S:\ or the Z:\ path above
protontricks-launch --appid 8930 "$HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe"

ls "$CIV5_DOCS/MODS"
ls "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC" | rg -i 'VPUI|UI_bc1'
ls "$CIV5_PFX/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V/Assets/DLC" 2>/dev/null

# [Game] MODS > enable the VP mods > NEXT (never Back) > Single Player
# [Game] Options > Leader Scene Quality: Minimum; autosave every 1 turn

```

17. Path reference

Wine prefix root	\$CIV5_PFX
Drive mappings	\$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/dosdevices
Mods	\$CIV5_DOCS/MODS
CP options file	\$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(1) Community Patch/Database Changes/ NewCustomModOptions.xml
Cache · per-mod user data	\$CIV5_DOCS/cache · \$CIV5_DOCS/ModUserData
Logs · logging switches	\$CIV5_DOCS/Logs · \$CIV5_DOCS/config.ini
Saves (single · multi)	\$CIV5_DOCS/Saves · \$CIV5_DOCS/Saves/multi/auto
EUI tooltip text	\$CIV5_DOCS/Text/VPUI_tips_en_us.xml
Real game install	\$CIV5_GAME
Crash artifacts	\$CIV5_GAME/crashlogs, and CvMiniDump_*.dmp beside the game executable in \$CIV5_GAME
VP UI · EUI · modpack	\$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/VPUI · UI_bc1 · VP_MODPACK
Replaced BNW package	\$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Expansion2.Civ5Pkg
Added city-state sound XML	\$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Sounds/XML/ MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml
Steam library, other packagings	\$3, second table
civ5vp-installer data	~/.local/share/civ5vp-installer
Phantom tree (stays empty)	\$CIV5_PFX/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/ Sid Meier's Civilization V

18. Sources

The Vox Populi source tree and releases:

Installer behaviour: two-path wizard, setup types, DLC gate, cache and legacy-folder deletion, mod folders rewritten on install, Uninstallable=no, Expansion2.Civ5Pkg swap, Inno Setup, savegame compatibility rule, Installer v1.2 requirement list Mod dependencies, EUI rules, VPUI/UI_bc1 destinations, audio rationale; Squads is QoL CustomModOptions rules and toggles 1.0.3.279 + all DLC; logging keys; minidumps Option Class legend and the Events overhead Minidump filename pattern, location beside the executable, dbghelp.dll dependency Blank issues disabled; required fields; the three attachments; crashlogs path; the 0/1 autosave rationale Report-writing guidance, Lua API, group movement page 5.4.6 stable, asset name, sha256 Game-core DLL imports MSVCR90 and MSVCP90 Modpack: Ctrl-Shift-M, cache rules, removal	LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL – VPSetupData.iss, scripts/release.py, Opener.rtf (1)/(2)/(3a) INSTRUCTIONS.txt and MANUAL INSTALL.txt; (4a) Squads modinfo (1) Community Patch/Database Changes/NewCustomModOptions.xml VP README.md, DEVELOPMENT.md, docs/minidumps.md NewCustomModOptions.xml header docs/minidumps.md .github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE/bug_report_v5.yml and config.yml Community-Patch-DLL wiki GitHub releases + release feed, 2026-08-31; still the newest release on 2026-09-19 CvGameCore_Expansion2.dll, both 5.4.6 variants, PE import table (5) Modpack Maker modinfo, ModpackMaker.lua
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Community threads and third-party projects:

Prebuilt modpacks incl. Linux/Proton build; MP autosave and log-collection guidance; open 5.4.x desync report; Info Addict memory warning Late-game CTD from 32-bit memory; Leader Scene Quality, yield icons, maps and resolution; beta vs stable naming Autosave recommendation; Workshop and DLL conflicts; don't delete after the installer; minimal-install triage; compatibility list Linux mod handling: DLL exclusivity, Workshop unreliability under Proton, MODS location, cache + ModUserData, known-good mods; Documents-path warning; launch first; first configure pass may crash once Runtime-library report and its variables; Debian/Ubuntu Steam path in use Achievements via VP's own option; native Linux map-achievement breakage Steam Linux Runtime breaks Protontricks Alternative installer: 0.1.6, asset, sha256, data dir, local-build warning MPPatch last release Dec 2023 Original copy-the-Assets workaround	CivFanatics modpack thread 685164; posts #721 (2026-09-05) and #732 (2026-09-19) for the last two, with Community-Patch-DLL issue #13349 CivFanatics "Welcome to the Community Patch sub – Start Here" thread 701813 CivFanatics "What is Vox Populi – How To Install" thread 528034; "MODS compatible with Vox Populi" thread 542679 CivFanatics thread 702075 (schubman, 2026-02-13 → 2026-03-19), now stickied Thread 702075 page 2, posts #21–#23 (2026-09-13 → 2026-09-16) bmaupin/civ5-cheevos-with-mods README, citing Community-Patch-DLL issue #12965 TeaDrinkingProgrammer guide issue #3 Alpakinator/civ5vp-installer README, CHANGELOG, v0.1.6 assets; CivFanatics thread 704249 Lymia/MPPatch release feed, 2026-09-19 TeaDrinkingProgrammer GitHub guide
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Linux, Proton and packaging:

LARGE_ADDRESS_AWARE default; GAME_DRIVE and its 11.0 default; fsync switch; DX9/DX11 launch report

Protontricks CLI, option order, prefix warning, Flatpak overrides and aliases, distro-package advice, cabextract error 1.12.0 appinfo.vdf floor; Steam directory discovery incl. Flatpak, Snap, STEAM_DIR; WINEPREFIX override; fsync default; the not-Proton and Flatpak-access messages vcrun2008 and corefonts contents, skip if installed, -q, cabextract requirement WINE_DISABLE_NICE read nowhere

Package versions and repos

Ubuntu, Debian and Fedora package names, versions and Steam install steps; NVIDIA 32-bit libraries on Debian

Steam default dir and ~/.steam/root
Debian/Ubuntu Steam directory

Steam disk write error on case-mismatched depot folders
Early-crash thread fix; NVIDIA, DX9/DX11 and audio reports

ValveSoftware/Proton README and proton script – proton_9.0, 10.0, 11.0 and experimental_11.0; Proton issue #8327 Matoking/protontricks README + TROUBLESHOOTING.md; flathub manifest docs

protontricks 1.14.1 CHANGELOG.md, steam.py, util.py, cli/command.py, gui.py, data/scripts/wine_launch.sh

Winetricks/winetricks src/winetricks (20260125)

ValveSoftware/wine proton_11.0 and CachyOS/wine-cachyos source trees archlinux.org package DB; mirror.cachyos.org packages.ubuntu.com, Launchpad; packages.debian.org, sources.debian.org; Repology (Fedora); Debian wiki: Steam as indexed, and a Debian 12 write-up that follows it; RPM Fusion command as quoted by Fedora guides; Flathub setup pages Arch Wiki: Steam

steam-installer 1.0.0.85 source: debian/steam-installer.README.Debian, debian/scripts/steam.in; thread 702075 #22 ValveSoftware/steam-for-linux #13406, #13436 ProtonDB public data export, 2026-09-01: 196 reports for app 8930

19. Limits

- **Thread 702075 page 1 is still not readable verbatim** — a fetch of that page returns only its metadata, so the opening post's content here comes from indexed excerpts; page 2 (posts #21–#23) was read in full, last on 2026-09-19. Everything structural is taken from the Vox Populi source tree instead, which is why this document contradicts the thread on the Assets/DLC folder name and treats the copy step as avoidable.
- **The S: default was read from Proton's source, not observed.** Proton 11.0 and Experimental enable gamedrive for every game in their launch script, and the s: link lives in the prefix's dosdevices, where a later protontricks-launch should still find it. The Step 1 check settles it, and Z: always works.
- **The runtime-library step rests on one forum report and the DLL's import table.** It was not reproduced on a clean prefix here; it is cheap, and Winetricks skips anything already installed.
- **§3 was checked against package indexes and upstream documentation, not run** on Ubuntu, Debian, Fedora or a Steam Deck. Versions move; the Protontricks 1.12.0 floor is what matters.
- **ProtonDB's page renders only with JavaScript.** Its public data export (2026-09-01) was read instead; the §7 and §13 items drawn from it are community reports, not tested fixes.
- **§9.1 toggles were read from the source file, not exercised.** ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS carries the project's own "functionality not guaranteed" marking and changes the savegame format.
- **The two upstream sources disagree on where crash dumps land** — the issue form says crashlogs, the minidump guide says beside the game executable. Both are covered rather than resolved.

- **Written against 5.4.6.** Wizard page order and setup-type names have been stable across recent releases but are not guaranteed; the sha256 is for 5.4.6 only, and VP ships betas alongside stable releases.
- **Untested paths:** Flatpak and Snap Steam (procedure holds, paths move), the 43-civ variants, MPPatch, and civ5vp-installer's local DLL build.